

FROM SHY STUDENT TO CREATOR

ISHAN SHARMA'S YOUTUBE JOURNEY

just the connection I have with my audience. People who are my age look up to the things that I've done, be it the brands I've worked with, be it the opportunities I've gotten, and they actually believe

that it is possible for them to also achieve the same. And I think that's the best part about the work that I've done so far.

What is it about being a creator that most people don't understand?

I think the hardest part about being a creator is that most people don't know how hard it is to keep going, to keep making videos, to keep showing up when you do not hear the claps. So when I started making my first few videos, I used to get single-digit, double-digit views and anyone would be disheartened. But those are the fundamental days, the fundamental years when you should absolutely be putting in the work to get to a place in which you can have millions of followers, millions of views. That impact starts from creating videos. And I think that is the cold start problem for content creation that most people don't fully understand or they underestimate.

What are some of the challenges and opportunities of being a content creator in India?

There are basically two main challenges of being a creator in India: The AdSense doesn't pay you as much because of the purchasing capacity of the Indian audience. Advertisers have been paying us very low CPMs, because of which we have to heavily rely on brand deals. This is a big struggle. The second biggest challenge is that people don't look at content creation as a very high-value thing. They actually look down on it, or that you're just a creator making videos in front of the camera, but creating content goes much more than that. It's an entire business in and of itself, but it doesn't get the respect it does in other places in the world here in India.

Your advice for wannabe content creators in India?

I think you should learn a lot about how content goes viral and how platforms work even before you create videos. Just know that most of the learning will happen on the ground. You just can't read a book for swimming; you actually have to get into the pool and learn through real, raw experience. There's no getting around that reality. **d**

For Ishan Sharma, content creation began not as ambition, but as a workaround for a personal limitation. "I just didn't have the courage or the confidence to go up to people and start having a conversation," says Ishan. So he turned to YouTube as a way to start conversations – first with seniors, then with a growing audience. What started with simple weekly chats in 2020 soon evolved into a disciplined content grind, documenting skills, freelancing journeys, and real-world learnings – ultimately helping him scale both confidence and a community.

In your own words, how would you describe your content?

I've been making videos for 6 years now but the central motto has always been to spread awareness for people my age because when you have more awareness, you make better choices in life and in your career. And the most unique thing about me, in my opinion, is